Brigham Young University-Idaho

Technology for the 21st Century
ED 211 – Fall 2020, Sections 2 and 5

Instructor: **Benjamin Pacini** (But seriously, call me BroPa.)

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Description: This course is a survey of 10 commonly used edtech tools. Students will be responsible for demonstrating their capacity at implementing these 10 tools in order to foster community, increase student achievement, enhance collaboration in a global and digital society, develop digital citizenship, become strong potential education job-candidates, and help teacher-candidates and their future students to achieve their unique, divine potential.

Office Hours: 10:00-11:00 & 1:00-2:00 Tues/Thurs. Fri 11:00-12:00. Other times by appointment***

Class Time and Place: Section 2: Tuesdays and Thursdays from 9:00-10:00 AM HIN 307 (and online)
Section 5: Tuesdays and Thursdays from 2:00-3:00 PM HIN 307 (and online)

COURSE INTRODUCTION AND INVITATION:

What is school for? Is it for this? Or maybe for this? Maybe this guy has it figured out?

Story time: It was 2008 and I was tall and nerdy. (Little has changed in that regard.) I was running to economics class--the land of graphs, equations, and percentages--and I was THRILLED to get there. Why? Because my professor was throwing out the scope-and-sequence to give real-time commentary on what was happening in the "great recession." I learned about CDO's and ratings agencies, and Lehman Brothers, and TARP and a whole lot more, and it was one of the best classes I ever took. He taught us ***what was going on,*** why it ***was happening***, and what it ***meant for the future***.

ED211 was developed by the department because they felt prompted (lol, right, sure) that there was a need to increase the amount of technological fluency among future teachers at BYU-I. (*wide eyes dot gif*) This is a crash course on *classroom* technology, but let's be honest, we're going to talk about a lot more technology than just that. In other words, I'm supposed to say something about how important this class is--but if you don't see it as compelling already (while you're sitting in your zoom room reading this online document) um, you have problems that I'm not sure I can fix. :)

You will master EdTech tools, of course--that's the foundation of this class--but you'll also question why 'school' is built the way that it is, how to be a compelling job candidate in a very different job market, and what technology has to do with helping your students succeed (hint: everything). The goal is *not* simply to have you master 10 tech tools--it's to learn how to master tech tools. The tools we learn in class will be obsolete in five years. Your job is to *learn how to learn.* You'll learn how to use technology to reach the one, and then you'll realize all the ways that the Lord is using it to reach you. There will be sweat involved (hopefully a fair amount) and perhaps tears (hopefully a small amount) and I don't

*I'm a terrible texter. I'm mediocre at answering phones, but I do try. I'm an excellent emailer. Best of all is the zoom channel, which I'll show in class.
** Google voice is great because it has a great spam screen. But, like, there's a spam screen. You'll need to say your name to get through. It's helpful if you say "student" too so I know who they heck you are, and that you aren't trying to sell me a vacuum. (I detest vacuum salespeople.)
*** I am very flexible at finding times to work with you if you reach out. While I'm off campus Mon/Wed, I can still chat by phone!

apologize for being an overly-excited, happily intense, moderately insane personal trainer. In all seriousness: consecration is the path to meaning and purpose. Feel the burn--and love it!

Welcome to Ed 211. Buckle up. We're going to have fun. So excited to have you!

Brother Benjamin Pacini

BYU Idaho Mission:

BYU-Idaho's mission is to develop disciples of Jesus Christ who are leaders in their homes, the Church, and their communities.

BYU Idaho Institutional Learning Objectives:

1. **Disciples of Jesus Christ:** Disciples of Jesus Christ have a testimony of Jesus Christ as the Son of God and strive to follow Him.
    1) Understand Doctrine and Principles of the Restored Gospel
    2) Make and Keep Covenants
    3) Live Standards of Honor and Integrity
    4) Work as Faithful Stewards of The Lord

2. **Sound thinkers:** Sound thinkers frame and solve problems using creative and critical thinking.
    1) Problem Solving
    2) Critical Thinking
    3) Inquiry and Analysis
    4) Innovation/Creativity

3. **Effective Communicators:** Effective communicators develop and express ideas that are purposeful, organized, and clear.
    1) Structure Content to Accomplish Specific Purposes
    2) Follow Appropriate Processes of Content Development
    3) Address Targeted Audiences Using Appropriate Modes of Delivery
    4) Express Ideas Clearly

4. **Skilled Collaborators:** Skilled collaborators work effectively with others to accomplish a shared vision.
    1) Fulfill Individual Responsibilities
    2) Facilitate Contributions of Others
    3) Foster Productive Group Climates
    4) Respond to Conflicts in Constructive Ways

How does this relate to our class?

I think you will find that every one of these ILOs is reflected in the design of this class. This is a happy accident: I did not know the ILOs when I was preparing. We will be working together in groups (ILO 4.2) to assess the quality of various EdTech tools (ILO 2.2). We will make a podcast (ILO 3.3) to explain what the quality of various EdTech tools are (ILO 2.2) , and edit it and add music, fade-ins, etc. (ILO 3.1) We will discuss the role of discipleship in teaching, and how teaching is a holy art. (ILO 1.4) We will talk about the potential of students, and your own potential as children of God. (ILO 1.1) We will do all of this in the context of living up to the honor code, (ILO 1.3) of making the world better

through innovation and education, (ILO 1.4 and ILO 2.4) and through finding ways to help and serve even in times of strain.

I suspect there are more ties--but I hope you can feel the light and inspiration coming from these. They have been crafted through inspiration, and striving to live up to them will be a blessing to you.

COURSE OVERVIEW:

Department goals:
The department publishes the required course outcomes for ED 211. The focus of this course is to:

1) Model community-building through technology, with a focus on collaboration and digital citizenship;
2) Enhance student achievement through technology tools;
3) Prepare leaders in EdTech implementation who are capable of evaluation, implementation, and ongoing reflection;
4) Prepare future teachers for a competitive, dynamic job market;
5) Empower teacher candidates to understand and shape the future path of education; and
6) Allow teacher-candidates to grow in their discipleship of Jesus Christ, realize their full potential, and develop the unique, divine potential of others.

The course content is based on Idaho core curriculum skills for students in the K-8 setting.

Essential Questions:
- What is educational technology?
- How can I effectively integrate technology into my teaching?
- How can I use technology to create effective and engaging lessons?
- How can I tell if people read the essential questions the answer is penguins?
- How do I manage students while using technology in the classroom?
- How can I teach and instill good habits and citizenship with students using technology?
- What technology skills are schools looking for in future job candidates?
- How do I evaluate the quality and cost of EdTech tools?
- How does EdTech relate to the gospel of Jesus Christ?
- What is school for?

Required Common Assessments:
1. Portfolium Assignment.
2. including at least 5 of the major projects from this class, such as:
    - GoReact Self-Assessment Project
    - Digital Teacher Professional Introduction Video
    - Flipgrid Project
    - Nearpod Project
    - Interactive Video Project (e.g. PlayPosit)

Course KUDOs:
Students will know the following:
Students will understand the following:
Students will be able to do the following:

ISTE Standards:
The technology skills you will learn are based on the standards developed International Society for Technology in Education (ISTE). The standards and the evidence from class assignments are listed in the following table:

International Society For Technology in Education (ISTE) Standards	Evidence
1. Facilitate and inspire student learning and creativity Teachers use their knowledge of subject matter, teaching and learning, and technology to facilitate experiences that advance student learning, creativity, and innovation.	IWB Board Lesson Screencast Lesson
2. Design and develop digital age learning experiences and assessments Teachers design, develop, and evaluate authentic learning experiences and assessments incorporating contemporary tools and resources to maximize content learning in context and to develop the knowledge, skills, and attitudes identified in the Standards.	IWB Board Lesson Assessment Presentation Tech Evaluation Penguins are not evidence
3. Model digital age work and learning Teachers exhibit knowledge, skills, and work processes representative of an innovative professional in a global and digital society.	Video Canva Posters
4. Promote and model digital citizenship and responsibility Teachers understand local and global societal issues and responsibilities in an evolving digital culture and exhibit legal and ethical behavior in their professional practices.	Presentation dress code Digital Citizenship Lesson Plan ePortfolio
5. Engage in professional growth and leadership Teachers continuously improve their professional practice, model lifelong learning, and exhibit leadership in their school and professional community by promoting and demonstrating the effective use of digital tools and resources.	ePortfolio Self-reflection assignments

REQUIRED COURSE MATERIALS:

You will need a working laptop, an internet connection, and a google email (you have one through BYUI). Your computer should work. (I'm not kidding.) You should join Zoom via computer. Note: you will never be required to pay for apps, but if you have already purchased them you are welcome to use them. As a teacher, it's important to find a way to spend as little as possible to get the job done. Reach out if you can't access a technology. You should also have a pair of quality headphones, and potentially a microphone for recordings.

NOTE ON REMOTE LEARNING ETIQUETTE:

The Honor Code, common sense, professionalism, and basic thoughtfulness should be the first place you visit with questions. If you're living the spirit of the law on those things, most of the below is already obvious. If you have questions about etiquette, asking early is professional and appreciated. Teacher-candidates should consider what they would expect

of their students in a classroom, and should do more than the bare minimums of compliance. Here are some tips to be helpful, though:

- Please dress professionally for Zoom sessions in the same way as you would for class.
- If you can't turn on your camera, I won't count you as present. I also might kick you out. Mostly because it's hilarious to kick people out randomly, but also because turn your camera on.
- Students should not leave a class session in-progress. Leaving a class may impact attendance.
- By default, please mute yourself unless you are contributing to class discussion.
- Use the hand raise feature and comment thread to indicate you have a comment or question.
- Please wear headphones or earbuds for audio, as it improves the clarity of sound for listeners.
- You should be in a location that is conducive to learning, and not distracting for others. Refrain from walking, driving, or otherwise moving during Zoom classes. If you believe there is an exception, it is your responsibility to reach out before that class occurs. I typically am very willing to allow exceptions if brought early.
- Please refrain from eating, grooming, exercising, skinning of wild beasts, etc. while tuning in to the live class. If you wouldn't do it in class, please don't do it in zoom. If you normally skin beasts in class… we should talk.
- Some counsel: set a routine for yourself that will allow you to focus during class. Consider building a focus plan. I will not play "gotcha" with questions, but I expect you to pay attention.
- Find a quiet, clean space from which to tune in. It is your job to let others know that you are in class. I have kids--I get it (and you'll probably see them, no matter how hard I try!) I expect your best, and will give mine.
- For presentations, please be engaging. It's kind to peers, but it's also great preparation for your classroom.
- In general, students should have back-up plans for technology difficulties as a matter of scholastic preparedness and also as a professional-in-training.

COURSE POLICIES AND EXPECTATIONS:

A note on structure:
Many structures in classes--like deadlines, late penalties, attendance points, etc.--are more for students than instructors. If you feel that you can succeed in class without them, I'm happy to give you a shot. I only ask that you come to my office hours to make your argument. Be warned: you're asking for more accountability, not less.

In a very serious way, I believe that The Lord does this too. He's happy to dispense with lower laws in favor of higher laws as we prove ourselves, and are willing to take on more responsibility. But many who complain about "the letter of the law" don't really want to live a higher law, they don't want to live up to the levels they are being asked to. Know yourself well enough to know where you are. And if you're ready for something with more freedom and more accountability, come see me. I love seeing students own their learning in this way, and am happy to take away the guard rails--so long as you recognize that you're taking on more responsibility.

Remember this when you become a teacher: the structure is for students. If not, get rid of it. And some students will be able to do without. You should let them.

Statement on dress code, masks, and honor code:
I'm evil.

Try me. I dare you.

maniacal laugh

Dress Code:

- For regular classes attendance: BYUI-approved dress and grooming standards. Masks required.
- For Presentations: Show effort in your appearance to present and demonstrate professionalism. Masks required.

Late Work

You can always submit work early--and are encouraged to. Major projects that are submitted on time or early may be ***submitted and resubmitted as many times as necessary to get to the grade you desire***[1]. You will also get feedback on each submission to help you improve the quality of your work: the goal is to learn from the process of submission, feedback, improvement, and resubmission. Late submissions on ***major projects only*** will not be penalized but you only get one shot to submit. You will get somewhat less feedback if you submit late, and you will be graded by me. I will not intentionally grade you harshly, but I do tend to grade more harshly than peers and TAs.

Some assignments cannot be submitted late by their nature (like group presentations). Submitting them late without prior approval will result in an automatic zero grade. Minor assignments are generally not accepted late. Again, this is to keep you on track.

Please be mature and professional about extenuating circumstances. (e.g. family vacations are not emergencies, and even emergencies are your responsibility to talk with me about.) You will find me to be very understanding, if you are very responsible.

Links:

It is your responsibility to ensure links are correctly shared so that I can access them. If they are not, you will receive the grade as though it had not been submitted (either zero or with a regular late penalty). Note that late penalties will not go away with resubmission in the case of broken links.

Course Breakdown:

- **Groups**: You will sort yourselves into groups in the first session of class. Your group membership is one of the most important predictors of your success in this class. You should get each other's numbers, text early and often, connect, and consider each other running buddies. (A running buddy is both a friend and an accountability partner.) If your group is running at peak-efficiency, you will make good friends and have a deeply joyful experience. Please let me know ASAP if your group is struggling with communication or work completion.
- **Major projects**: The major work of the class is contained within projects. These projects are meant to teach you how to be an expert in the use of specific educational technologies. These projects can always be submitted early, and can be resubmitted as many times as needed to earn a high grade--if the project is submitted before the deadline. These projects will all be put into one place (Portfolium) so that future employers can see your excellent work, and that of your projects.
- **Readings**: I assign an eclectic blend of readings from practical to silly to inspiring and joyful. My goal is to teach you to learn to read in different ways (e.g. carefully or quickly) depending on need, and also to start a habit of regular, careful consumption of education research, news, and current events. There will be four readings available each week. Each member of your group should pick a different one. You should spend a total of one hour on readings each week: about 45 minutes reading and commenting in PerusAll, and another 15 or so

[1] Mastery Based Learning (first conceived of by the brilliant--and brilliantly named--Benjamin Bloom) is a different education paradigm where we flip time and mastery. Rather than hold time constant, and let mastery fluctuate, MBL says that you can take all the time you need on a project, but you must get an excellent score on it. This means that students can work ahead, and go slower if needed. It's really good stuff, and I highly recommend you check it out. See here for more details. (The video is meh, but the documents are pretty good.)

explaining the importance of your reading on FlipGrid. If you finish early, you can spend the time on other additional readings (on the readings list). If you don't finish, you should stop at an hour.

- **Reflections:** Reflections are primarily for your benefit: the point of this class is to leave you with capacity in various tools, but the ability to apply their use wisely is in your court. There are two major parts to the reflection project: one is an end-of-course reflection (that is pretty easy) and another is an ongoing google doc where you should put ideas, ideas, improvements, etc. I will read both. You will start this in the first week of class.
- **Contribution to Community**: One of the most important parts of this class (to me) is modeling for you how important a strong community is. It is also to model for you that it is possible to form a community even in odd conditions (like during Covid lockdowns). You will be asked to do fun, silly, joyful things just for the sake of making connections. You'll also be asked to do one more major project (that is still small in grade terms) that helps the class in some way.
- **Technology proficiency exam**: Google, Microsoft, and Apple all offer competency exams in the use of technology in their particular brand. It is required for graduation that you succeed in passing this assessment, and so I have made it worth a grade in this class to ensure that you get it done. It is only worth a small amount, but should encourage you to get it done. You should be able to get it done fully independently, but I will offer reminders during class.

Participation and Attendance

Attendance is necessary--but not sufficient for--success in this class. It will be graded--but so will disposition, your contribution to this community, and the way that you collaborate. One of the primary goals of this class is to teach you how to build communities intentionally, and I will be grading you on your contributions. Dispositions are particularly important: I want you to build the habits of character to be intentionally positive, solutions-oriented, creative, genuine, proactive, friendly, etc--precisely because there is so much negativity in the world. It matters more than you know. Do not plaster on a fake smile--be authentic. Ask questions, participate, and build others up. Be present in class (that means two different things: do both).

High-Flex

This class is intended to be as flexible as possible. Some students will be completely remote, others will be able to attend in class, and most of you will be able to do some of both. At present, the plan is to be ready to shift to online in case of lockdown, but to use in-class time for activities that are the most high-value. Other activities will be done online.

For example, imagine that there are three activities that need to be done in a span of three class sessions, as follows:

	Class session 2	Class session 3	Class Session 4
Group 1	In-person	Online Activity 1	Online Activity 2
Group 2	Online Activity 1	In-person	Online Activity 2
Group 3	Online Activity 1	Online Activity 2	In-person

Groups will attend together. For online activities, groups will hold devotional together, and then engage in the learning as outlined.

For students who are not able to come to class (because of distance, or should a student be quarantining) they should attend class as best as they can with their group (there is an option to Zoom into in-person classes). I will do everything I can to make in-person classes meaningful through Zoom--but you'll have to try your best to understand what we're aiming for, too!

I will attempt to record all class sessions, but you should not rely on those as recordings sometimes fail. You should get the information you need from class. In the event of technical failure, students are still responsible for the learning that takes place in sessions. Attendance matters in both synchronous and asynchronous classes.

Questions and Communication
In the first week of class, you will learn about our zoom channel: please check it daily. While I'm always happy to answer questions, please do all you can to ask peers and consult class materials (e.g. syllabus) before reaching out. Questions that may apply to the whole class can be asked in the Zoom chat; personal questions should be emailed. I encourage people to ask their group first, the zoom channel second, the TA third, and BroPa fourth--to build your capacity to answer your own questions. That said, just ask! I love interacting with students, and will happily answer even if you go out of order.

Grading:
Please reference the University's grading explanation here.

Letter Grades will be assigned according to the following scale:

A	93-100	A-	90-93	B+	87-89	B	83-86
B-	80-82	C+	77-79	C	73-76	C-	70-73
D+	67-69	D	63-66	D-	60-62	F	0-59

Grade Breakdown:

10%	Technology Competency Exam
20%	Contributions to Community (including attendance)
20%	Readings & Reflections (and other minor assignments)
20%	Group Presentation and Grading
30%	Portfolium (all major assignments)

Grading Procedure and Philosophy:
You will do a lot of peer grading and peer feedback. You are about to be teachers, so this is good training. I expect you to grade with **kindness, honesty, and care**. While you will give suggested grades, I am ultimately responsible for grades in this course.

If you would like to appeal a grade, please email me. Note that I will regrade any assignment once--but I regrade the full assignment, not just the piece that a student may feel was unfair.

Here is the general grading scale that I use for most rubrics, which is based off the DCPS Essential Practices rubric (the formal evaluation rubric used for scoring teachers professionally in Washington D.C.)

Highly Effective (4/3)	Effective (3/3)	Developing (2/3)	Ineffective (1/3)
Quality is that of an experienced, highly effective teacher. Student achievement will be strongly positive as a result of this learning experience.	Quality is that of a highly-motivated college student who has done high-quality work. Student achievement will be positive as a result of this learning experience.	Quality is that of average college student quality. Student achievement will be flat because of this learning experience.	Does not meet the criteria for a score of 2.

Notice that in the rubric above, you can earn up to four points on an assignment, but the grade is only out of three points. This means that I can hold a high bar of rigor, while still allowing you a chance to grow into your full capacity as a teacher. Receiving a three would count, grade-wise, as getting an A. But getting a four would mean that you are doing

impressive work *for a veteran, highly effective professional educator.* This lets me hold you accountable in a fair way, that also lets you excel--while still maintaining a high bar of rigor.

Note on Emotional Health

We are struggling, nationally, with emotional well-being. This is important for your future students, but it's also important for you, right now, as human beings. One of my goals in this class is to help equip students with the habits, frame of mind, and resources to become resilient and emotionally strong. I believe strongly that creating emotionally strong, resilient students is about both decreasing stress, and increasing capacity. If discussions of emotional health are sensitive or difficult for you, please let me know as early as possible. I do not claim to have all the right ideas on this, but feel it to be important enough to bring up and discuss.

Additionally, I suspect that many of you lean toward perfectionism: teaching will help with that. You will learn, quickly, the art of "good enough." You should never feel the need to spend 3 hours on a 1 hour assignment. Be wise. Learn how to manage your own time carefully. Learn that excellence is better than perfectionism (including in grades) and know the difference between integrity and scrupulosity.

A thought on emotional health and grades: I hope all of you are aiming for an A. But I hope you realize that the real goal isn't the A, it's the learning--it's the success that you'll have in your classroom someday because of what you learned, the students' lives who will be changed, and the relationships you'll build with teachers, parents, students, and communities--and most importantly, the Lord. This is a very long-term game. You will see your success measured not in months, or even years, but decades and generations.

Sensitive Topics
The world is in tremendous turmoil. The devil is stirring men's hearts up unto anger, and it's hard to even have conversations on some topics. Elder Paul V. Johnson has asked faculty to have both "moral courage" and "intellectual courage." I do not believe that it is in your best interest for me to avoid difficult conversations. To the contrary, learning how to wrestle with difficult topics is one of the most important things you can take from your BYU-Idaho education. As such, I will attempt to do so with openness, sensitivity, and honesty. If there are questions that are important to you, don't hesitate to ask me privately--and if appropriate, I may raise such issues in class, as well. I should also be clear that everything these days is politicized, and everyone is angry. The solution is not to disagree less, but to disagree better. I do not expect you to agree with everything I say--I only expect respect and civility. In that context, I'm happy to discuss things that are pressing to you.

Lockdown Possibilities
I sincerely hope we do not have to transition to fully remote classes--but I am ready just in case. Please do what you can to be ready as well--and what you can to prevent spread to begin with.

Course Calendar
The Course Calendar outlines all assignments, topics, and modules of the class. The instructor reserves the right to make changes in the schedule and syllabus. Students will be informed of changes in a timely manner. This calendar may be found in the i-Learn course materials, and is attached here as well.

Survival Guides and Exemplars: How to Survive ED211 (and BroPa):
Past students have done great work at putting together online survival guides for this class. They have also included some of the highest graded work for various projects in the class. You can find some of them here. Please be aware that **grading expectations change from semester to semester**, and that these are presented as helps, not as definitive "I-will-get-an-A-if-I-copy-this-exactly" exemplars.

Syllabus Changes

This syllabus is a guide and every attempt is made to provide an accurate overview of the course. However, circumstances and events may make it necessary for the instructor to modify the syllabus during the semester and may depend, in part, on the progress, needs, and experiences of the students. Changes to the syllabus will be made with advance notice.

Cheating/Plagiarism
All students attending BYU-Idaho have agreed in writing to adhere to the Honor Code. Cheating, which includes plagiarism, will not be tolerated. This includes using materials you did not create and claiming them as your own. Using ideas and resources shared in the teaching community is supported, however you must give attribution and add your own ideas, experience, etc. to found resources. Please check with the instructor before using resources such as Teachers Pay Teachers and Influencer produced materials. Anyone caught cheating will receive a zero on the assignment or exam, will be reported to the Student Honor Office, and may be expelled from the course.

Academic Support
Go to http://www.byui.edu/AcademicSupport , or come to the McKay Library 272 for information about how the writing, reading, math, and study skills centers can help you increase your success in all of your classes. To schedule a tutor for a specific class, log on to the Academic Support website, click on Tutor Request under Student Services and follow the instructions.

Disabilities Act
In compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act, all qualified students enrolled in this course are entitled to "reasonable accommodation." It is the student's responsibility to disclose to the teacher any special need she/he may have before the end of the first week of class. Students with qualifying disabilities should contact Disability Services at disabilityservices@byui.edu or 208-496-9210. Additional information about Disability Services resources can be found at the Disability Services website.

I am very easy to work with on this. Please know, however, that the best thing I can do for any student is give them resources, empower them, and hold them to a high bar. Talk with me early if I can help in any way.

Sexual Discrimination
BYU-Idaho prohibits sex discrimination against any participant in its education programs or activities. Prohibited sex discrimination includes incidents of sexual harassment (including sexual violence), dating violence, domestic violence, sexual assault, and stalking (collectively "sexual misconduct"). Title IX also covers student-to-student sexual harassment. As an instructor, one of my responsibilities is to help create a safe learning environment for my students and for the campus as a whole. University policy requires that I report all incidents of sexual misconduct that come to my attention. If you encounter sexual misconduct, please contact the Title IX Coordinator at titleix@byui.edu or 208-496-9209. Additional information about sexual misconduct and available resources can be found at www.byui.edu/titleix